

Intercession Prayers for the Living

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General categories for prayer.

Everyone has certain things that “resonate” with them. These are the things that resonate with me. I have them listed for the Jesus prayer (or other prayers, see below – the one I usually use is the first listed, because it is an adaptation of my favorite verse, John17:3) in the morning.

The things that resonate with me and you may be different. This is my list. Make it your own, or make a different list, but, without fail, make a list! The world is full of terrible things, but also the beautiful One, Who abides in our hearts. We must pray about these terrible things, and in so doing, we emulate the Beautiful One. Priest Seraphim Holland seraphim@orthodox.net

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/general-categories-for-personal-prayer.pdf>

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For each category (or group of categories), say:

“Lord, have mercy on ... and grant that they may know Thee, the only True God, and Jesus Christ, Whom Thou hast sent.”

Or:

“Lord, have mercy on ... and grant that they may know come to know Thee, by the Holy Spirit.”

Or:

“Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on ...”

Or:

“Lord have mercy on ...”

This document location:

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/general-categories-for-personal-prayer.doc>

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General Categories – the Living

Persecuted because of their faith

1. All persecuted & being martyred.

Illness

1. All who are dying.
2. All with cancer.
3. All who are in chronic pain.
4. All with disabilities.
5. All who are ill.
6. All who care for the ill, and those who need constant care.
7. Parents of very sick or disabled children.

Grief and loss

1. All who lost someone suddenly.
2. All who had a great loss.
3. All who are troubled by grief.
4. All who have been victims of violence.
5. All who have witnessed or survived violence.

Personal trials – Personal History

1. All who have been abused.
2. All in prison.
3. All slaves.
4. All sexual slaves & sex workers.

Personal trials - thoughts

1. All who are contemplating suicide.
2. All who are without true purpose.
3. All with PTSD
4. All who are anxious.

5. All who are depressed.
6. All who are in despair.
7. All who are in great stress.
8. All who are lonely.
9. All who do not fit in.
10. All who have trouble coping.
11. All who have been or feel abandoned.

Mental and Spiritual illness

1. All who are delusional.
2. All demoniacs.
3. All who are mentally ill.
4. All drug addicts.
5. All with persistent thoughts & fantasies.

Sexual & sexually related sins

1. All who contemplated, had or support abortions, participated in them or are indifferent.
2. All who are sexually immoral.
3. All sexually confused or gender confused.
4. All addicted to pornography & fantasies

Secular – in the church

1. All who are secular.
2. All who baptize their child and do not teach them the Christian life, in word and deed.
3. All who inquire about baptism and do not follow through.
4. All estranged from the church.
5. All ecumenists & false teachers.

Secular – not in the church

1. All schismatics.
2. All heretics.
3. All unbaptized.
4. All atheists.
5. All believers in false gods & religions.
6. All scoffers & blasphemers.

Priests

1. All priests who have failed to serve and protect.
2. All priests who are weary, cynical, or suffering any great temptation.
3. All abusive clergy.

Monastics

1. All monastics who are not watchful.
2. All monastics having great temptations.
3. All monastics who have gone into the world.

Personal sins

1. All who are spiritually ignorant.
2. All who are lazy.
3. All who rarely pray.
4. All who do not know how to pray.
5. All who are not kind.
6. All who are indifferent about the suffering of others.
7. All who are abusive.
8. All who hide their sins or problems.
9. All who do not forgive everyone.
10. All who are bitter.
11. All who know what to do and do not have enough strength or desire to do it.

My personal ministry

1. All in my parish
2. All in my prison ministry
3. All those I have met or influenced.
4. All those I have judged, sinned against, hindered, offended or harmed.

General Categories – the Departed

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. All who died today.2. All within their 40 days.3. All who died suddenly.4. All who died violently.5. All who died unprepared.6. All who died of overdose7. All who died while intoxicated.8. All who died in despair.9. All who died in bitterness.10. All who died in anger. | <ol style="list-style-type: none">11. All who died w/o asking forgiveness of those they wronged.12. All who did not have a burial.13. All whose family do not pray for them.14. <i>ATTGM</i>: All who died w/o repentance.15. <i>ATTGM</i>: All who died by suicide.16. <i>ATTGM</i>: All who died estranged from the church.17. <i>ATTGM</i>: All who died unbaptized.18. All who died throughout the ages. |
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Various Prayers for the living

Prayer of St Silouan of Mount Athos:

I pray Thee, O merciful Lord, for all the peoples of the world, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

Old Believer Prayer Book, pg 312

O Lord grant mercy unto them that bear hatred or enmity against me, and also unto them that revile or slander me: That none of them may at all suffer any evil, whether in the present or in the age to come, on account of me, who am impure. But cleanse them all in Thy mercy, and protect them by Thy grace, O Thou who art good.

For all I have judged or wronged

My God, have mercy on everyone I have judged and everyone I have wronged – if I have given any alms, give the reward to them instead.

St. Paisios of Mount Athos, quoted in biography "St. Paisios of Mount Athos" by Hieromonk Isaak, pg 425

A small prayer

O Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on all who are bent over and help them to rise up.

A prayer for tears

Lord, give me tears so that my heart can weep day and night out of love for my brother! *St.*

Silouan An Athonite Gerontikon, page 362, On compunction and tears.

Pastoral Attentiveness

Holy Elder Porphyrios, help me to have pastoral attentiveness and discernment.

"Elder Porphyrios, Testimonies and experiences", by Kiltos Ioannidis, pg 94. Italics not in original prayer

I am a wretch.

My God, I am a wretch. Have mercy on me, and the whole world too. *"St Paisios of the Holy Mountain", by*

Hieromonk Isaac. Pg 530

Help my brother and me.

"O God, help my brother and me, through his prayers! *(St Gaza of Dorotheos)*

To pray for someone more diligently:

From the Old Believer Prayer Book, with line 4 added

Save, O Lord, and have mercy on **Thy servant(s)**

_____, [bow]

Deliver him (*her, them*) from every tribulation, wrath and need [bow].

From every sickness of soul and body, [bow]

Forgive him (*her, them*) every transgression, voluntary and involuntary, [bow]

Teach them to pray and to live with purpose. [bow]

And do whatever is profitable for our souls. [bow].

Prayer of Elder Paisios for the Whole World

Our Lord Jesus Christ:

Do not abandon Thy servants who live far away from the Church. May Thy love convict them and bring them back to Thee.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who are suffering from cancer.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who suffer either from small or serious ailments.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who suffer from physical infirmities.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who suffer from spiritual infirmities.

Lord have mercy on our leaders and inspire them to govern with Christian love.

Lord have mercy on children who come from troubled homes.

Lord have mercy on troubled families and those who have been divorced.

Lord have mercy on all the orphans of the world, on all those who are suffering pain and injustices since losing their spouses.

Lord have mercy on all those in jail, on all anarchists, on all drug abusers, on all murderers, on all abusers of people, and on all thieves. Enlighten these people and help them to straighten out their lives.

Lord have mercy on all those who have been forced to emigrate.

Lord have mercy on all those who travel on the seas, on land, in the air, and protect them.

Lord have mercy on our Church, the bishops, the priests and the faithful of the Church.

Lord have mercy on all the monastic communities, male and female, the elders and eldresses and all the brotherhoods of Mt. Athos.



Lord have mercy on Thy servants who find themselves in the midst of war.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who are being pursued in the mountains and on the plains.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who are being hunted like birds of prey.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who were forced to abandon their homes and their jobs and feel afflicted.

Lord have mercy on the poor, the homeless and the exiled.

Lord have mercy on the nations of the world. Keep them in Thy embrace and envelope them with Thy holy protection. Keep them safe from every evil and war. Keep our beloved homelands in Thy protective embrace day and night. Embrace her with Thy holy protection defending her from all evil and war.

Lord have mercy on those who have been abandoned and have suffered injustice. Have mercy on families that are going through trying times. Pour Thy abundant love upon them.

Lord have mercy on Thy servants who suffer from spiritual and bodily problems of all kinds.

Lord have mercy on those who are despairing. Help them and grant them peace.

Lord have mercy on those that have requested that we pray for them.

Lord grant eternal rest to all those who have passed on to eternal life throughout the ages.

This prayer of his was given to a convent which had asked the Elder for a prayer rule that could be used by the nuns in their evening vigils. This directive was given to the nuns during the final years of his life. It would be correct to add intentions as your heart directs, and to say this prayer as part of your daily rule.

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/of-elder-paisios-for-the-whole-world.doc>
<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/of-elder-paisios-for-the-whole-world.pdf>
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**Prayer for all the peoples of the world,
according to the model of the prayer of St Silouan of Mount Athos.**

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, for all the peoples of the world, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst relieve the hunger and suffering of those who do not have enough to eat, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to repentance those who can alleviate the suffering of the hungry, but do nothing, or even actively increase the suffering of Thy servants, they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst relieve the sickness and suffering of those who are ill, and especially those who suffer because of civil war, oppression, neglect and poverty, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and make safe those who are suffering from war, and killing, and civil unrest, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and guard from anger, bitterness and despair those who have lost loved ones because of the inhumanity of men. Help them to not return hatred for hatred or murder for murder, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst enlighten and bring to repentance those who kill and rape and plunder from their fellow man, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and protect and women and children and men who are trafficked as slaves, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and protect and women and children and men who are abused physically, sexually, verbally and emotionally, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou would bring to sobriety, peacefulness and love and those who are angry and nursing grudges, and planning retribution for wrongs they

have suffered, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst enlighten and clarify the thinking of those who hate Christianity and the church because of personal experiences, and prejudices, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit. And if we have caused anyone to stumble because of our sins, we beseech Thee - forgive! and give us a path to rectify our wrongs.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst make steadfast and those who are suffering persecution, deprivation, slander and danger because of their true belief in Thee, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort, protect and bring to repentance those who are incarcerated, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and guard from ill Thoughts and actions and those who are suffering unjustly for something they did not do, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort, give purpose and joy and those who are in despair, feel no purpose in their lives, or are contemplating suicide, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to full sobriety, mental clarity those who suffer from mental illness, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to full sobriety, mental clarity those who are possessed or oppressed by demons, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst enlighten and bring to repentance those who kill and torture and dominate others in the name of a false God, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, That Thou wouldst enlighten and bring to repentance those who kill and profit from and promote the killing of babies in the womb, and children, and the elderly and the feeble, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst comfort and enlighten and bring to repentance and fill with true joy, purpose and those who are contemplating killing their unborn child, and those who have killed their children, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst help those who have committed a great sin, and have great sorrow, to know thy forgiveness and to grow in hope, and love, and joy, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to repentance and those who are advocating for or attempting to impose abortion upon anyone, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to repentance and true belief and moral purity and politicians who promote and subsidize all immorality, the killing of the unborn and feeble and disenfranchised or the subjugation the poor, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to repentance and true belief and moral purity and those who teach

indecent things because of greed, or ignorance or any other hidden sin, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst help and those who know what is right and are afraid to speak the truth, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou would enlighten and bring true belief and purpose those who do not believe in Thee, or oppose Thee, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee O Merciful Lord, that thou wouldst increase peace in families, and mutual love between all, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst teach spouses to put aside any divisions and grow to perfection in Thee through loving each other, with peace, mutual comfort, and tranquility, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst help spouses to keep their marriage bed undefiled, never with lust or selfishness or perverse practices, and always increasing their love for Thee, that

they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst guard children from the pernicious effects of our unbelieving society and that they would grow in their faith, unto the stature of a perfect man, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst help Fathers and Mothers to do the one thing needful for their children, and with patience and wisdom raise them in the fear of Thee and piety and remember to pray for them with tears every day, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst teach siblings to love each other as their neighbor and not have petty squabbles and disputes, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst prosper the church and not let any one of our children, loved ones and friends be lost to unbelief, lukewarmness or depravity, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to repentance and purity and those who fornicate and do impure sexual things, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst break the bondage of those who are addicted to pornography and all uncleanness and bring them to the knowledge of Thee, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst bring to wholeness and purity and those who are engaged in the homosexual lifestyle or gender confusion and give strength to those who have illicit sexual attractions to live in purity and holiness, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou wouldst give courage and steadfastness to those Who have true belief in Thee, whose lives, families and property are at great risk because of the spectre of militant Islam, atheistic governments, or any totalitarian system that hates true Christianity, that they may come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst comfort and give true joy and to
those who are in despair because of drug
addiction, that they may come to know
Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst help those who do not live
according to purpose to learn their purpose,
that they may come to know Thee by the
Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst enlighten and bring to repentance
and true faith those who proclaim heresies,
that they may come to know Thee by the
Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst bring to repentance and Christian
action and those of us Who do very little to
help our suffering brother, that they may
come to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst forgive me my terrible sins, and not
let any one of them cause my brother to
stumble, that they may come to know Thee
by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst help me to love my enemies, that

they may come to know Thee by the Holy
Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst open my heart to the sufferings of
others, that they may come to know Thee
by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst help me to judge rightly regarding
my brothers, but never to disdain them
because of their sins, that they may come
to know Thee by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst season my foolish words with salt,
that all may come to know Thee by the Holy
Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst teach me to pray with attention
and love, that all may come to know Thee
by the Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, that Thou
wouldst help all peoples to have the
remembrance of death and to have their
treasure in heaven and not among the
things of the world which are passing away,
that they may come to know Thee by the
Holy Spirit.

I pray Thee, O Merciful Lord, for all the
peoples of the world, that they may come

to know Thee by the Holy Spirit. Amen.

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-all-peoples-of-the-world-according-to-the-model-of-the-prayer-of-silouan-of-mount-athos.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-all-peoples-of-the-world-according-to-the-model-of-the-prayer-of-silouan-of-mount-athos.pdf>

A Prayer for Priests

O Lord, let

Thy priests _____ be clothed with righteousness;

Let them always remember the greatness of their calling;

Let them not be entangled in the snares of the world and the devil;

Let them be saved from the cares of the world, the delight in riches,

cowardice, equivocation, duplicity, undue regret, despondency, anger, coldness, exhaustion, judgment of others, cynicism, negativity, laziness, forgetfulness regarding prayer, indifference, unawareness, lack of empathy, aloofness, manipulation, heresy, schism, being too opinionated

and the desire for other things entering into their hearts.

St. John of Kronstadt

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/of-john-of-kronstadt-for-priests.html>

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A Prayer of Intercession for All People

From the First Kneeling Prayer, Vespers on Pentecost.

O Most-pure, spotless, unoriginate, invisible, incomprehensible, unsearchable, immutable, invincible, immeasurable, forbearing Lord, who alone hast immortality, Who dwellest in light unapproachable, Who hast made heaven and earth and sea, and all that is therein, Who unto all grantest their petitions before thy ask:

We pray Thee and we ask Thee, O Master, Lover of mankind, the Father of our Lord and God and Saviour Jesus Christ, Who for us men and for our salvation, came down from the heavens and was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and the Ever-virgin Mary, the most glorious Theotokos; Who, having first taught in words, and afterwards instructed by deed, when He had endured the saving Passion, granted unto us, Thy lowly and sinful and unworthy servants a precept that we should offer prayers unto Thee, with bowing of the neck and knees, for our own sins, and for the errors of the people.

... Now, therefore, do Thou hearken unto us who pray unto Thee, and

remember us the lowly and condemned, and turn again the captivity of our souls, having Thy loving-kindness interceding for us.

Accept us who fall down before Thee and shout: We have sinned; on Thee were we cast from the womb, from our mother's womb, Thou art our God.

But inasmuch as our days were consumed in vanity, we were bereft of Thy help, we deprived ourselves of any defense; but presuming upon Thy compassions, we cry: The sins of our youth and ignorances remember not, and from our secret sins cleanse us, and cast us not away in the time of our old age, when our strength faileth; forsake us not even until we return again into the earth, vouchsafe us to return unto Thee; attend to us through Thy good favour, and grace; measure our transgressions with Thy compassions, set the abyss of Thy compassions against the multitude of our sins.

Look down from Thy holy height, O Lord, upon Thy people ... looking for abundant mercies from Thee.

Visit us with Thy goodness, deliver us from the assaults of the devil; establish our life upon Thy holy and sacred commandments.

Commit Thy people unto a faithful guardian angel, gather all into Thy kingdom, grant pardon unto them that hope in Thee; remit their sins and ours.

Cleanse us by the working of Thy Holy Spirit; destroy the wiles of the enemy directed against us.

A Prayer of Supplication & Intercession for All People

From the Second Kneeling Prayer, Vespers on Pentecost.

O Lord Jesus Christ our God, Who hast bestowed upon men Thy peace, and the gift of the Holy Spirit; Who, while still on earth and present with us, didst grant an inalienable inheritance to the faithful, but more visibly hast sent down ... grace ... upon Thy disciples and apostles, and hast strengthened their lips with fiery tongues, whereby we, together with the whole race of mankind, having received the knowledge of God in their own tongues in the hearing of our own ears, have been enlightened by the light of the Spirit, and have been changed from delusion as from out of darkness, and through the distribution of the material and fiery tongues, and the supernatural activity were taught to believe in Thee, and

kindled to bless Thee together with the Father and the Holy Spirit, in one Godhead and might and authority:

Do Thou, O Effulgence of the Father, immutable and immovable Image of His essence and nature, the Fountain of wisdom and grace,

open the lips of even me a sinner and teach me how I ought to pray and what needs to pray for; for Thou knowest the great multitude of my sins, but Thy loving-kindness will overcome their immensity.

For, behold, in fear I stand before Thee, having cast the despair of my soul into the abyss of Thy mercy: do Thou pilot my life, O Thou Who by a word dost direct all creation by the unutterable might of Thy wisdom, O peaceful Haven of the storm-

tossed, and cause me to know the way wherein I should walk. Grant unto my thoughts the Spirit of Thy wisdom, bestowing upon my foolishness the Spirit of understanding; overshadow my doings with the spirit of Thy fear, and renew a right spirit within me, and with Thy governing Spirit establish my sliding thoughts, so that being daily guided by Thy good Spirit in things profitable, I may be enabled to keep Thy commandments, and ever to bear in mind Thy glorious Coming, and those things worthy of torment that we have done.

And do not suffer me to be captivated by the corruptible beauties of this world but strengthen me in the desire to attain the treasures of the world to come.

For Thou hast said, O Master, that whatsoever one may ask in Thy name, he shall freely receive it from Thine ever-existing God and Father. Wherefore, I also, a sinner, ... entreat Thy goodness to grant me whatsoever I have asked which is unto salvation.

Yea, O Lord, abundant Giver of every benefit, Bestower of good things, for Thou it is Who dost most abundantly

grant that which we request; Thou art compassionate and merciful, having without sin been a participant in our flesh, and in Thy compassionate loving-kindness art inclined toward those that bow the knee before Thee, having been the propitiation for our sins.

Grant then, O Lord, Thy compassions unto Thy people; hearken unto us out of Thy holy heaven; sanctify us with the might of Thy saving right hand; shelter us with the shelter of Thy wings, and disdain not the work of Thy hands.

Against Thee only have we sinned, but also Thee only do we serve. We know not how to worship an alien god, nor to stretch out our hands, O Master, to another god.

Forgive us our sins, and having accepted our supplications ..., stretch out unto us all a helping hand; receive the prayer of all as pleasing incense, acceptable before Thy most blessed kingdom.

